

smooth, and there are pretty much no lags or frame drops even during long gaming sessions. This is where the higher clock speed of the Snapdragon 695 SoC's big cores comes into play – 2.2GHz vs the 2.0GHz clock speed of the Snapdragon 4 Gen 1. The Redmi Note 12 5G, on the other hand, didn't render graphics as smoothly and we did experience frame drops or lags at certain points. Now, while the Realme 10 Pro 5G offers a better gaming experience, the smartphone heats up more than the Redmi Note 12 5G. After a 15-20 minute gaming session of Call of Duty Mobile, the Realme felt quite hot, while the Redmi Note 12 5G managed thermals much better.

Battery

Coming to battery, this is where the Redmi Note 12 5G showed better results, barring a couple of exceptions here and there. Both the Redmi Note 12 5G and the Realme 10 Pro 5G come with 5,000mAh batteries and both support 33W fast charging. On paper, things are even. However, when it comes to the actual battery experience, the Redmi Note 12 5G gave us slightly better battery life. During our time with the two devices, the Redmi Note 12 5G was able to give more on-screen time in one battery cycle as compared to the Realme 10 Pro, but the difference wasn't too vast.

During other tests as well, the Redmi Note 12 5G showed better efficiency as compared to its rival. Watching 30 minutes of YouTube video on the maximum setting for 30 minutes only drained 4 percent of the Redmi Note 12 5G's battery life, as against the 6 percent drop for the Realme 10 Pro. Further, a 15-minute gaming session on Call of Duty: Mobile drained only 5 percent of the Redmi Note 12 5G's battery, while the same drained 9 percent of the Realme 10 Pro's battery. While in most things the Redmi Note 12 5G's efficiency was better, using GPS navigation on the Redmi Note 12 5G for one hour surprisingly drained twice the amount of bat-

tery than it did on the Realme 10 Pro 5G. Charging speeds on the two are also pretty much the same, with the Realme 10 Pro 5G charging from 0 to 100 in just 65 minutes as against the Redmi Note 12 5G, which took 67 minutes to charge from 0 to 100.

Display

The display tech on both the Redmi Note 12 5G and Realme 10 Pro 5G are different from each other, but the resolution and refresh rate remain the same. The Redmi Note 12 5G comes with an AMOLED display, while the Realme 10 Pro 5G comes with an IPS LCD display. While the 1080 x 2400 pixels resolution on the Redmi Note 12 5G and the Realme 10 Pro is the same,



the AMOLED panel on the Redmi Note 12 5G feels far more superior in terms of sharpness and colour accuracy. The Redmi Note 12's display also feels more smooth, despite both the phones having the same 120Hz refresh rate.

Not to take away from the Realme 10 Pro's LCD display, which also feels very premium going by LCD standards. Looking at these displays side-by-side, the Redmi Note 12 5G's display feels more rich overall. The colours are more dense and the detail is much better, thanks to the AMOLED panel that Xiaomi has used. Now, while the difference between these two displays is quite evident, the LCD on the Realme is also brilliant in terms of details and quality, if we go by LCD standards.

Many screens on the smartphone seemed similar, but obviously, the Redmi Note 12 5G's display just feels more vibrant.

In terms of touch response as well, the Redmi Note 12 5G felt more slick. Swiping between screens took less effort on the Redmi Note 12 5G, as compared to the Realme 10 Pro 5G. Further, I also experienced accidental touches on the Realme 10 Pro a few times, not so much on the Redmi Note 12 5G.

Coming to brightness, here also, the Redmi Note 12 5G was a clear winner. The smartphone's AMOLED display is much brighter than the LCD panel on the Realme 10 Pro 5G. In our Lux Meter test, the Redmi Note 12 5G showed a peak brightness of 816 nits, as compared to the Realme 10 Pro's 658 nits tested peak brightness. It is important to note here that the Realme 10 Pro 5G came very close to the claimed peak brightness of 680 nits. The Redmi Note 12 5G, on the other hand, has a claimed peak brightness of 1200 nits, which is farther from the tested brightness.

Overall, the Redmi Note 12 5G easily takes the lead over its most direct competitor. Having an AMOLED display doesn't just give you a better quality image, it's also more efficient and consumes less battery as compared to an LCD panel.

Camera

Another subjective thing, cameras. Here also, the Redmi Note 12 5G and Realme 10 Pro 5G offer different things. While the Realme 10 Pro 5G offers a dual rear camera, the Redmi Note 12 5G comes with a triple rear camera setup. However, the primary shooter on the Realme 10 Pro 5G uses a 108-megapixel sensor, paired with a 2-megapixel depth sensor or portrait lens. The Redmi Note 12 5G, on the other hand, has a 48-megapixel primary shooter, an 8-megapixel ultra-wide angle lens, and a 2-megapixel macro shooter.

In terms of performance, however, the 48-megapixel sensor on the Redmi Note 12 5G stands tall against the 108-megapixel shooter of the Realme